

# Senku

User Guide — a quiet workspace for one master folder

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Senku is a local Windows desktop app that pairs a live file browser with one-time, text-first tasks. It does not organize, copy, move, or sync your files. It only remembers paths, tasks, and preferences, and gives you a fast way to see and open the things you already have.

This guide covers what Senku actually does in this build, including a few places where the behavior is simpler than you might expect from the name of a setting.

# 1. Getting started

## First launch

When you open Senku for the first time, it shows a setup screen because no workspace exists yet.

- 1 Enter your name.
- 2 Enter a workspace name, for example **BTech 24-28**.
- 3 Paste the folder path you want Senku to watch (your **master folder**), or click **Browse** to pick it.
- 4 Select **Create workspace**.

The workspace name is a label inside Senku only. Your real Windows folder is never renamed, moved, or touched.

## What a workspace is

A workspace pairs one master folder with its own tasks, its own Strict Mode setting, and its own browsing history. You can have several workspaces — for example one per semester, or one for placement preparation — and switch between them at any time from the sidebar.

# 2. Browsing your files

The file panel shows the current workspace's master folder exactly as it exists in Windows.

- Double-click (or click) a folder to open it inside Senku.
- Double-click a file to open it with whatever application Windows normally uses for it.
- Use the breadcrumb trail at the top of the panel to jump back to a parent folder, or the home icon to return to the master folder itself.
- **Copy path** copies a file or folder's full Windows path to your clipboard.
- **Rename** renames the real file or folder on disk. Senku does not create a copy.

Senku only ever shows what is inside the current master folder. It will never display, or let you browse to, anything outside it — even if a task links to a file elsewhere.

Renaming changes the actual file name in Windows. Any shortcut, other app, or Senku task link that refers to the old name may stop working until it is updated.

# 3. Tasks

A task is a one-time, text-first reminder. It does not need to be linked to anything — a task with no linked files is still a valid reminder.

## Creating a task

Click the **+** button in the tasks panel, or **Add a new task**, and fill in:

- **Task name** — plain text.

- **Start time** — when the task should notify you. Times in the past are allowed.
- **End time** — defaults to ten years after the start time, so you rarely need to touch it.
- **Priority** — Normal or Urgent (see Strict Mode below for what this actually changes).
- **Linked paths** (optional) — one file, folder, URL, playlist, or repository link per line.

## Task actions

| Action                 | What it does                                                                                                |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Done / checkbox</b> | Marks an active task as Completed.                                                                          |
| <b>Snooze</b>          | Adds 10 minutes, 1 hour, 1 day, or 1 week to the start time and re-arms the reminder.                       |
| <b>Reassign</b>        | Saves your current progress as Completed, then opens a dialog to schedule the remaining work as a new task. |
| <b>Edit</b>            | Changes the title, times, priority, or links of an active or error task.                                    |
| <b>Recover</b>         | Fixes an Error task's links and moves it back to Active.                                                    |
| <b>Delete</b>          | Removes the task from Senku only. The linked file or folder is never touched.                               |

Opening a linked file never marks a task complete on its own. Completion is always something you do deliberately.

## 4. Strict Mode — what it really does

Every task sends a Windows notification at its start time, no matter what. That part never changes.

Strict Mode is a single switch **per workspace**, not per task. When it is on, any task with linked paths — Normal or Urgent — has all of its links opened automatically the moment it starts. When it is off, links are never opened automatically; you open them yourself from the task.

Task priority (Normal vs. Urgent) only changes the wording of the notification title. It does not, by itself, force links open — only the workspace's Strict Mode toggle does that. If you were expecting Urgent tasks to always open their links even with Strict Mode off, that is not how this build behaves.

Turn Strict Mode on or off from the toggle in the sidebar, under the workspace's task list.

## 5. When a linked path fails to open

If Strict Mode tries to open a task's linked path and cannot — the file was moved, deleted, or the path was mistyped — the task moves to the **Error** view. Its title, schedule, priority, and every linked path (including the one that failed) are kept exactly as they were.

- 1 Open the Error view from the sidebar.
- 2 Select **Recover** on the task.

- 3 Fix or remove the broken linked path, then save.
- 4 The task returns to Active and will run again at its next start time.

This build does not yet show you the exact reason a link failed inside the Error view — you will see that a task “Needs attention”, but not the underlying error text. If a task keeps failing, double check the path still exists and is spelled correctly.

## 6. Overdue and Completed

A task that is still active when its end time passes moves into the **Overdue** view — it is not deleted or hidden, just flagged as past due until you act on it.

The **Completed** view keeps a history of everything you have finished, filterable by Today, Last week, or All. Completed tasks can be deleted from Senku at any time; this never affects the underlying files.

## 7. If Senku wasn't running at a task's start time

Senku checks every workspace once a minute while it is running, including once right after it launches. If a task's start time already passed while Senku was closed, that first check after launch fires the notification (and Strict Mode opens, if applicable) exactly once — you will never get the same reminder twice for one start time.

## 8. Where your data lives

Senku stores its own metadata — workspace names, master folder paths, tasks, and settings — as local JSON files under your Windows user profile. It never uploads anything and has no internet dependency.

```
%APPDATA%\Senku\data\
```

Deleting this folder resets all of Senku's memory of your workspaces and tasks. It does not touch any of your real files or folders.

## 9. A simple way to use Senku

- Keep one workspace per meaningful area of your life — a semester, a project, placement prep.
- Link a task to a single working document rather than many small files; keep notes, links, and to-dos inside that one document, and let Senku just point you back to it.
- Leave Strict Mode off if you mainly want reminders. Turn it on for a workspace where you want resources to open themselves the moment a task starts.
- Use Reassign instead of Delete when you made partial progress — it keeps a record of what you did and cleanly hands off the rest to a new schedule.